

Email Lifecycle Audit & A/B Test Plan

B2B Childcare SaaS · Marketing Analytics Assessment · Siddhartha Baniya

Context

This audit reviews an existing 22-email lifecycle campaign across MQL, Demo Booked, Post-Demo, Rescheduling, and Opportunity stages for a B2B SaaS platform serving the U.S. childcare market. The brief: diagnose where high-intent prospects are dropping off, identify what's working, and recommend a structured pilot test to improve demo bookings without burning list quality.

Key Findings

What's working

- Post-Demo stage emails reach ~45% open rate — the highest in the dataset, indicating strong intent at this stage.
- FCC-specific MQL email (EM1) gets 43.6% open rate — nearly double the open rate of generic MQL emails.
- Demo Booked stage CTR is strongest at 30–37%.

What's underperforming

- Rescheduling stage emails show only 10–17% open rate — high-intent prospects are slipping at the moment they need a frictionless rebook.
- MQL sequence decays from 24% open rate at EM1 down to 12% by EM5 — diminishing returns as the sequence runs.
- EM4 unsubscribe rate spikes to 2.05% — the highest in the dataset and a list-quality risk.

Bottom line: high-intent prospects are dropping off at the MQL and Rescheduling stages, and EM4 is actively damaging the list.

Recommendations

1. Stop sending EM4 and EM5 in the MQL sequence

Reason: EM4 has the highest unsubscribe rate at 2.05% and EM5 has the lowest open rate at 12% — both contribute negative net value.

Test: Remove EM4 and EM5 from MQL sequence for 90 days.

Goal: Reduce unsubscribes and protect long-term list quality.

2. Build more vertical-specific (FCC) emails

Reason: Only 1 FCC-specific email exists out of 22 total. The single FCC EM1 gets 43.6% open vs 24% for generic — nearly 2× lift.

Test: Build FCC-specific EM2 through EM5.

Goal: Increase FCC demo bookings.

3. Delay the Rescheduling Day 0 send to Day 1

Reason: SMB Rescheduling Day 0 gets only 17% open rate; Day 3 gets 33%. Same-day sends are too early — prospects need overnight to rebook.

Test: Send the first rescheduling email next morning instead of same-day.

Goal: Increase rebook rate.

Pilot Plan — FCC-Specific Email Sequence

Hypothesis: FCC-specific emails will increase demo bookings compared to generic emails.

Audience: FCC contacts only, split into two groups — control receives current generic emails; test receives new FCC-specific emails.

Message format & flow (4 emails total)

- EM1: FCC intro — licensing and billing pain points.
- EM2: FCC operator success story.
- EM3: Feature spotlight — parent communication and billing.
- EM4: Single CTA — book a free product demo. Sequence stops automatically when demo is booked.

Tools: HubSpot workflows, A/B testing, demo-booking tracking.

Timeline: Week 1–2: Build emails. Week 3: Launch. Week 4–10: Run test. Week 11–12: Analyze.

Success metrics: Open rate above 30%, demo booking rate +15% over control, unsubscribe rate below 1%.

Adjacent Channel — LinkedIn Sponsored InMail

LinkedIn Sponsored InMail open rates reach 50–60%, materially higher than email. Childcare directors and FCC owners are active on LinkedIn for professional development — licensing updates, staffing advice, compliance news. This makes LinkedIn a strong warming channel for cold audiences before they enter the email funnel.

Note

This work was originally produced as a take-home assessment. Company-specific references have been generalized; the analysis, recommendations, and pilot design are mine.